GRAMMAR ACTIVITIES UNIT 2:
Past Tenses

Past simple · Past continuous — Topic: Operating Systems & Virtualization

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1 Past simple: affirmative, negative and questions

Complete the sentences with the verb in brackets in the past simple. Look at the type: (+) affirmative, (–) negative, (?) question. Then circle R if the verb is regular or I if it is irregular.

#	Type	Sentence	Regular / Irregular
1	+	The IT team installed *(install)* Ubuntu on the classroom computers last week.	R / I
2	–	The virtual machine didn't start *(not / start)* because there wasn't enough RAM.	R / I
3	?	Did you create *(create)* a snapshot before the update?	R / I
4	+	I chose *(choose)* VirtualBox as the hypervisor for my project.	R / I
5	+	Microsoft released *(release)* a new Windows security update yesterday.	R / I
6	–	We didn't give *(not / give)* the VM enough disk space.	R / I
7	?	Which operating system did they use *(use)* on the server?	R / I
8	+	The technician configured *(configure)* the network adapter in bridged mode.	R / I
9	+	My laptop froze *(freeze)* during the Windows update.	R / I
10	–	The students didn't back up *(not / back up)* their files before they formatted the disk.	R / I
11	?	Did the administrator send *(send)* you the login credentials?	R / I
12	+	She built *(build)* a virtual lab with three Linux machines.	R / I
13	+	The antivirus deleted *(delete)* an infected file from the system.	R / I
14	–	The old PC didn't run *(not / run)* Windows 11 because of its old CPU.	R / I
15	?	How long did the installation take *(take)*?	R / I

REMEMBER (–) didn't + base verb · (?) Did + subject + base verb · regular verbs: -ed · irregular verbs: 2nd column (choose → chose)

2 Past simple & past continuous

Complete the sentences with the past simple or the past continuous. Think: which action was in progress (long) and which one interrupted it (short)?

TIP while + past continuous (long action) · when + past simple (short action) · was / were + verb-ing

1. While I was installing *(install)* Windows on the VM, the power went *(go)* off.
2. The server was working *(work)* normally when the hackers attacked *(attack)* it.
3. We were updating *(update)* the system when the screen turned *(turn)* blue.
4. What were you doing *(do)* when the virtual machine crashed *(crash)*?
5. He wasn't paying *(not / pay)* attention while the teacher was explaining *(explain)* how hypervisors work.
6. While they were configuring *(configure)* the virtual network, they found *(find)* a serious error.
7. I was downloading *(download)* a Linux ISO image when my Internet connection stopped *(stop)* working.
8. The technicians were testing *(test)* the new operating system when the boss arrived *(arrive)*.
9. Were you running *(run)* two VMs at the same time when the computer _____ *(freeze)*?
10. While the students were taking *(take)* the exam, the teacher saw *(see)* a virus warning on the screen.

Well done! Now write two sentences about a problem you had with a computer, using both tenses.

1. While I was updating the graphics driver, my computer screen turned completely black.

2. The antivirus found a malware file while I was downloading a program.